Be the reviewer

Critical appraisal checklist (10 questions)

Foundations of Clinical Research · Session 8 (8.3) and the manuscript peer review

Paper: *[First author, year, journal]*

Reviewer: *[Your name]*

Design (from Q2): ☐ RCT ☐ Cohort ☐ Case-control ☐ Cross-sectional ☐ Other

How to use this checklist

- Read the abstract, then Table 1, the primary outcome result, and the first and last paragraphs of the Discussion. You do not need to read every word.
- For each question tick Yes, No or Can't tell, and write WHERE in the paper you found the answer (section, page, table or line). "Can't tell" is a valid answer: it often means poor reporting.
- There is no total score. Questions 2, 4, 5 and 7 matter most for deciding whether to trust the result.
- Finish with a one-sentence verdict. Compare with the reporting guideline (CONSORT for trials, STROBE for observational studies). For a formal risk-of-bias tool, see Risk_of_Bias_Tool_Chooser.docx.

#	Question	Yes	No	Can't tell	Where in the paper
1	**Question**: Can you write the study's PICO in one line?	☐	☐	☐	
2	**Design**: What is the design, and is it the right one for the question?	☐	☐	☐	
3	**Participants**: Who was included, and who was left out? Would your patients have been included?	☐	☐	☐	
4	**Comparison groups**: Were the groups similar at the start (Table 1)? How was this achieved (randomisation / matching / adjustment)?	☐	☐	☐	
5	**Bias**: Who knew which group patients were in (blinding)? Could that change the outcome?	☐	☐	☐	
6	**Outcome**: Was there ONE pre-specified primary outcome, measured the same way in both groups?	☐	☐	☐	
7	**Numbers**: What is the main result as an effect size with 95% CI? Is the CI narrow or wide?	☐	☐	☐	
8	**Words vs design**: Do the conclusions match the design ("associated" vs "caused"; no "trend" for p = 0.42)?	☐	☐	☐	
9	**Limitations**: Are the main limitations stated honestly? Name one the authors missed.	☐	☐	☐	
10	**Use**: Would this change practice in your unit? Why / why not?	☐	☐	☐	

Main strength	Main weakness	One-sentence verdict